

Academy Snapshot

Sharing what Ten10 Junior Consultants are working on

Hi everyone, I'm Donnell from Academy 38. Currently, I am placed at NATS as Test Engineer, working as part of the Recording Services Bridging Project test team. Our system revolves around the recording of conversations between Air Traffic Control (ATC) and our pilots. The previous system, known as NICELOG, has been in service for over 20 years at four different sites and has reached the end of its life cycle, and our system is being put in place to replace it.

For the past 6 months we have been working through multiple test campaigns up in Prestwick, Scotland in order to transition from the old system to the new. I was able to be involved in system acceptance testing (SAT), where I could gain a deep understanding of how our system works and put some of the skills I picked up during my time in academy training. We then moved onto operational interface testing (OIT), where I was tasked with writing the test procedures that would be used for that phase. Again, I was able to use a set of skills honed in the academy to help drive a successful test campaign.

My time at NATS has been a very steep learning curve, where I was dropped into a fast-paced and critical project. While I have faced some challenges and some uncertainty, it has been a collection of challenges that I was excited to face and has allowed me to grow not only as a tester but as a person too. I have been able to forge new relationships with new colleagues, while also sharpening the blades in my tester's toolset. I am looking forward to what new challenges and opportunities await in the coming year.



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